

STUDENT SPOTLIGHT:
LAWRENCE SAPP

This interview first appeared in the March 2021
National Coordinating Center Newsletter.

What is your name, where are you from, and what college are you attending?

My name is Lawrence Sapp. I live in Waldorf, MD. I am a freshman at University of Cincinnati right now.

What classes are you taking, and which is your favorite?

I take Vocational Exploration. Financial literacy is the best [class]. I also take physical conditioning early in the morning on Monday, Wednesday, and Friday. It's a fitness class with the Army ROTC. I train for swimming in the afternoons and on weekends.

What do you like to do when not attending class?

I like to play video games and just chill in my dorm and relax. I like to play Division 2, Call of Duty: Black Ops 4, Batman: Arkham Knight.

What's it like living away from home?

I like it. I travel by myself, so it's OK.

What's good about college?

I like to go for a walk, swimming, relax on campus with friends, hang in the hammock on the trees, go to the bookstore and browse around and get all the gear you need.

Can you share anything about how COVID has affected your college experience, like maybe you learned something new, or overcame a challenge to attend virtual classes?

I had to quarantine in September because my roommate's mom tested positive for COVID. It was terrible. That was hard. For my classes, I have one class online, in the morning. Then I have some classes in-person, especially the fitness conditioning. Outside I can take my mask off, but in the rec center I leave it on. Fingers crossed it's different in the fall.

What do you hope to do after college, after you graduate or get your certificate?

I want to live and train at the Olympic Training Center with my TeamUSA (swimming) teammates, and be in the 2024 Paralympic World Games. I am competing this year, in 2021! If I get a job, I could be a lifeguard at the Rec center in Cincinnati. Really, anything to do with swimming.



Lawrence training for the Paralympics



My coach and my parents helped me decide to go to college. And I wanted to go to college.

—Lawrence on how he made the decision to go to college

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If you or someone you know would like to be interviewed, contact sheila.johnson@umb.edu for more information.



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What advice do you have for young students with disabilities who aren't sure about college?

I would give them a tour. I could be nice to them. I am older, so I would be nice. And I would recommend they go to college.

Who helped you decide about college?

My coach and my parents helped me decide to go to college. And I wanted to go to college. I looked at so many schools in my junior and senior years of high school—Arizona, University of South Carolina, Georgia Tech, Texas A&M, University of Delaware, Ohio State, and Cincinnati, and several Division 1 schools. I will always do my best in the four years at Cincinnati.

So why did you pick UC?

Because of the swimming program. Because it's my goal to have a swimming career and that's my future. And I've been going to Ohio since I was young.

Finally, if you could go anywhere in the world, where would you go?

Spain with some of my friends, or on vacation. Or Australia. Or Universal Studios.

[Click here to read an article about Lawrence and the Paralympics.](#)



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University of Cincinnati TRANSITION AND ACCESS PROGRAM (TAP)

The TAP provides a four-year college experience for adults with intellectual and/or developmental disabilities. Students enrolled in TAP live on campus, take at least one UC undergraduate course for credit or audit, and are enrolled in approximately four UC Transition and Access Program courses each semester. TAP courses are developmental and designed to support students in developing competencies related to vocational skills, self-determination (one's ability to see themselves as the causal agent in their life and act accordingly), social competence, independence, and community living.

Website: <https://cech.uc.edu/schools/education/ats/tap.html>



Thank you to Lawrence for his time and willingness to share a bit about his college experience!

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